

In-Betweens

Art Gallery Exhibition Catalog

SIGGRAPH 2026 Conference Chair
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Computer Graphics Annual Conference Series
A Publication of ACM SIGGRAPH



SIGGRAPH 2026
Los Angeles 19–23 JUL



Association for
Computing Machinery

Advancing Computing as a Science & Profession

The Association for Computing Machinery
1601 Broadway, 10th Floor
New York, New York 10019, USA

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ACM ISBN: 979-8-4007-2547-0

Preface

In-Betweens

The SIGGRAPH 2026 Art Gallery explores computer graphics and interactive techniques as languages and materials to express artistic visions and experiences. The theme “In-Betweens” highlights the interactions that the twelve installations establish with space, time, themes, and technologies.

Across media and approaches, including screens, projections, installations, sculptures, devices, wearables, bio art, data visualization, robotics, and space art, the Art Gallery brings together creators whose works address large-scale questions and humanitarian concerns; investigate foundational components such as algorithmic methods and computing hardware; expand how we perceive an increasingly interconnected world; and re-examine and speculate about our place within the layered infrastructures of contemporary technology.

Sternwerk, an interactive installation by Alvaro Cassinelli and Tobias Klein, transforms our ephemeral breath into an intimate reflection of deep time. Here, a meteorite sculpture gathers human breath, condensing it into droplets and absorbing the heat generated by the computation. In **SENSHO**, Ryuichi Ono and Tetsuaki Baba translate the glitch from screen culture into kinetic matter, using strobes, vibration, and touch to suspend a solid object between image, sculpture, and bodily sensation.

Several works approach “in-betweens” as a cultural and social condition. Weidi Zhang and Rodger Luo’s **A Walled City** turns uploaded images into AI-generated architectural chambers, building a collective monument to memory, density, and digital presence. Shirley Wu’s **in-between: home, belonging**, and the Asian diaspora gives fragile material form to migration, displacement, and the difficulty of defining home. Jeyun Cloud and Ziqian Yin’s **Are We Gazing at the Same Moon?** reimagines moon-gazing as a shared ritual across parallel memories, while Pinyao Liu’s **SOMA: In Search of Somatic Intelligence** shifts human–AI communication from language to bodily memory and robotic response.

Other installations examine AI not as an abstract system but as an interface, a pressure, and a cultural script. Avital Meshi’s **Stuck in the Middle** lets participants wear a conflict between clashing AI voices. Joey Verbeke and Koi Ren’s **Gradi** makes the seams of AI interaction visible through speculative wearable interfaces. Sihwa Park’s **Diffusion TV** uses the familiar form of a CRT television to reveal how diffusion models transform noise into images, linking artificial generation to questions of extinction, preservation, and ecological futures.

Other works extend the theme into biological and planetary scales. Yoon Chung Han’s **Dreaming Babies: illi** imagines chromosomal difference as poetic variation rather than defect. **Simulacra Naturae – Entangled Biomes**, by Nefeli Manoudaki, Jason Paterakis, Mert Toka, Diarmid Flatley, and Stejara Dinulescu, creates a cyberphysical ecology where organoid activity, algorithms, haptics, and fabrication co-evolve. **In The Long Fall: A Descent into the Ocean’s Living Memory**, Jiabao Li, Manu Prakash, Will Tallent, and Michael Bruner trace the microscopic labor of plankton across climate, ocean depth, and planetary time.

Together, the twelve works present In-Betweens as an active condition: a space where matter computes, bodies translate, memories assemble, and futures are negotiated.

Preface

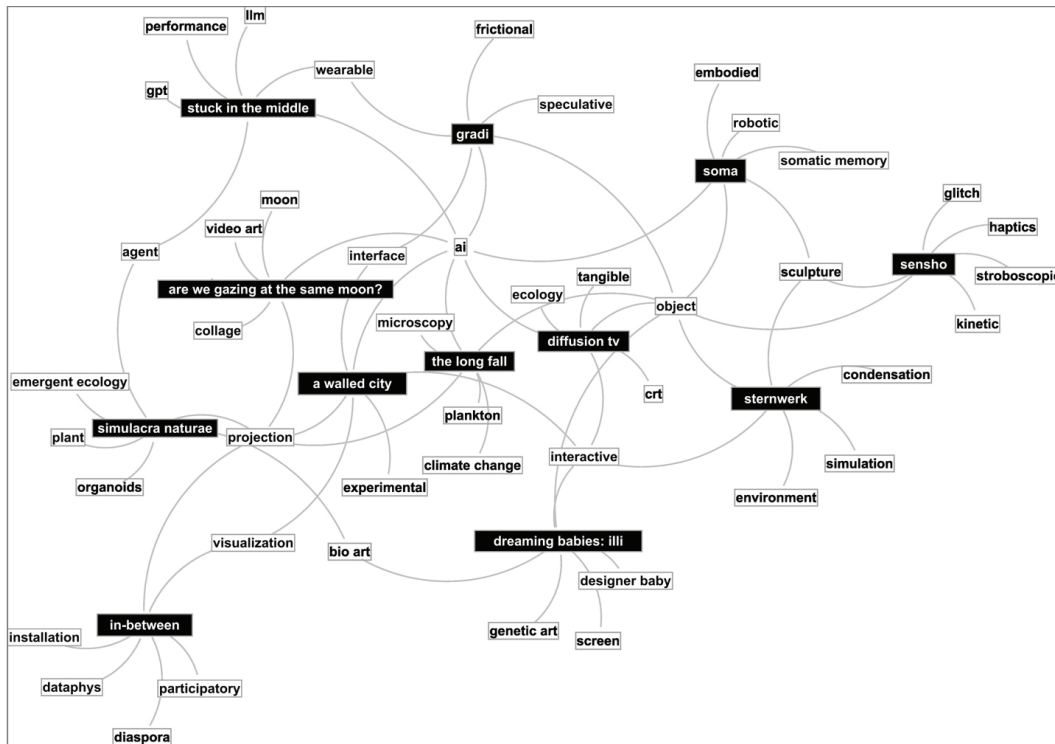


Figure 1. A network visualization of the 12 juried artworks

Two curated additions place In-Betweens within a longer history of computer graphics and digital art. Nearly 45 years ago—on Tuesday, August 4, 1981, at the Dallas Convention Center—SIGGRAPH’s Frame Buffer Show opened as the conference’s first state-of-the-art computer art exhibition. Its title marked a technical and artistic threshold: the frame buffer, where pixels were composed before appearing on screen. Today, that threshold has expanded into the GPU, whose parallel architectures power real-time graphics, simulation, and the matrix operations behind contemporary generative AI.

David EM Print Exhibition returns to this history from within it. As one of the artists and organizers of the original Frame Buffer Show, Em links the gallery to an early moment when pixels, software, and hardware were being claimed as artistic materials. Presented as prints, his works slow computation into contemplative surfaces, offering a quiet counterpoint to the immediacy of the gallery's real-time systems. Where Em's prints look back to the material and institutional origins of computer art, the **2025 Ars Electronica Animation Festival** carries the lineage into contemporary moving-image practice, through works shaped by ritual, motion capture, humanoid AI, plastic pollution, media spectacle, e-waste, and post-atomic landscapes. Read side by side, these curated additions extend the frame of In-Betweens: from frame buffers to GPUs, from early pixel experiments to animation, AI, and planetary imaginaries.

The SIGGRAPH 2026 Art Gallery would not have taken shape without the generosity, rigor, and care of many colleagues. I am deeply grateful to Conference Chair Chris Redmann for his support; to the jury—Rebecca Strzelec, Jurgen Hagler, Yoichiro Katsumoto, Avital Meshi, Gabriela Aceves, Robert Twomey, Philippe Pasquier, Anastasia Tyurina, Yoon Chung Han, and Şölen Kiratlı—for their thoughtful deliberations; and to the advisory reviewers—Angus Forbes, Behnaz Farahi, Clarissa Ribeiro, Claudia Mosqueda, Cynthia B. Rubin, Florent Di Bartolo, Jack Stenner, Johnna Brucker-Cohen, Johnny Di Blasi, Josh Rodenberg, Nik Aberle, Tobias Klein, Daria Tsoupikova, Bill Miller, Andrea Sosa, Scottie Huang, Jiabao Li, Laura Cinti, Jiayi Young, Haru Ji, Blanka Domagalska, Gustavo Rincón, Hyeon Nam, Paul Magee, and Giuseppe Torre—for their expertise and perspective. I also thank Stephen Spencer, Conference Administration, Conference Management, Event Marketing, Freeman Logistics, Linklings Content Management, and Tradeshow Logic for their essential support in bringing the exhibition to life.

Everardo Reyes, Art Gallery Chair, SIGGRAPH 2026